

02 · JOINT INJURY

Ankle Sprain Recovery Protocol

A phase-by-phase recovery framework for mild ankle sprains — from acute swelling through full return to dynamic movement.

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RECOVERY WINDOW

10 – 14 days

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

1

PHASE ONE

Acute Management

0 – 72 HOURS

- Elevation — raise the foot with the knee extended
- Compression of the ankle joint
- Cryotherapy (cold application) to reduce swelling
- Light foot movement in all directions, within pain-free range
- Topical cooling cream and anti-swelling / anti-hematoma cream

2

PHASE TWO

Subacute Recovery

3 – 10 DAYS

- Pain-free walking
- Restore full joint mobility
- Cycling for low-impact cardio
- Balance and proprioception work
- Cryotherapy, compression, and creams as needed

3

PHASE THREE

Functional Return

10 – 14 DAYS

- Strengthen the joint apparatus and surrounding muscles
- Reintroduce running
- Progressive change-of-direction drills
- Loaded exercises and plyometric jumps



RED FLAGS — WHEN TO STOP & SEEK SPECIALIST CARE

Stop training if pain increases, swelling does not subside, there is no improvement after 5–7 days, or you feel instability in the ankle.

Need a tailored program?

Get in touch for a personalized recovery and rehabilitation plan.

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